ELEVATOR PITCH

HELM

Helm is the operations autopilot for independent e-commerce brands — it runs the back office so the founder can run the business.

30 SEC A lift, a conference badge scan

Independent online stores lose twelve hours a week stitching inventory, fulfillment and support across tools that don’t talk to each other. Hiring an ops manager costs six figures, so most brands under two million just absorb the work themselves. Helm is an AI operations layer that connects the tools a store already uses and runs the repetitive work on its own — reorder alerts, shipment triage, refunds, daily reporting. The founder approves. Helm executes.

60 SEC A warm intro call, an investor at a demo day

Independent online stores lose twelve hours a week stitching inventory, fulfillment and support across tools that don’t talk to each other. Ninety percent of brands under two million can’t afford an ops manager, so the founder is the ops manager.

Helm is an AI operations layer. It connects the stack a store already runs — Shopify, the 3PL, the support desk — and handles the repetitive work autonomously: reorder alerts, shipment triage, refunds, daily reporting. Everything routes through a human-in-the-loop dashboard. The founder approves, Helm executes.

Fourteen hundred brands are on the waitlist. The pilot cohort is at eighteen thousand MRR, growing nine percent week over week, at an NPS of sixty-two. We charge seventy-nine to three ninety-nine a month by order volume, plus usage on automated actions.

90 SEC A partner meeting, the first ten minutes of a pitch

Independent online stores lose twelve hours a week stitching inventory, fulfillment and support across tools that don’t talk to each other. Ninety percent of brands under two million can’t afford an ops manager, so the founder is the ops manager — and the business stops growing at exactly the point it should be compounding.

Helm is an AI operations layer. It connects the stack a store already runs — Shopify, the 3PL, the support desk, the ad accounts — and handles the repetitive work autonomously: reorder alerts, shipment triage, refund handling, daily reporting. Everything routes through a human-in-the-loop dashboard, so the founder approves and Helm executes. Nothing happens to a customer that the founder didn’t sign off on.

This wasn’t buildable eighteen months ago. Agentic models only just became reliable and cheap enough to run unattended operations, and at the same time a record number of solo founders are launching stores with no back-office staff at all.

I spent eight years scaling DTC operations, the last of them at Shopify Plus. My co-founder led ML at two workflow-automation companies, both acquired. Fourteen hundred brands are on the waitlist, the pilot cohort is at eighteen thousand MRR growing nine percent week over week, and we’re raising one and a half million to reach five thousand paying brands and a million in ARR over eighteen months.